

Hear the Bell Ring!



There was a time when phones only beeped. But now, your mobile phone is an extension of your personality—the colours, themes and even the ring tone reflect who you are.

Today, almost all phone manufacturers allow new ring tones to be downloaded onto their phones. Ring tones can even be composed and exchanged between users. Some of the newer models such as the Samsung SGH-N620 offer polyphonic ring tones (tones that are composed of chords of notes, rather than single notes).

Music companies like BMI are also expanding their repertoire of activities to now include the creation of ring tones using the various brands and artistes they represent. Large music companies such as these are now signing agreements with companies such as **Zingy.com** and Sonera Zed, which create content for mobile phones. With the increasing popularity of GPRS and other mobile communications standards that allow for much richer multimedia and the new flurry of phones that can support these standards, your next ring tone could be your favourite song!

Here are numerous Web sites that provide ring tones, some of them paid, while others are free:

www.orange.co.in

www.mizone.bplmobile.com

www.nonstopsms.com

www.ringtonesgalore.co.uk

www.free-ringtones-free-logos.com

Panasonic EB-GD75



Light and elegant, feature-packed and great sounding—that's the Panasonic GD75 in a nutshell. This matt silver phone uses a Li-Ion battery pack and is surprisingly lightweight at just 81.86 grams. Its features include an impressive phonebook memory of 200 entries, and a high-resolution 1.5-inch monochrome screen that displays good-looking graphics and clear text. Navigation through the menu system is enabled through a very intuitive, small and easy-to-use five-direction joystick. Another distinguishing aspect of this phone is its support for polyphonic ring tones. With the ability to play more than one note simultaneously, this phone's ring tones sound richer. The phone also includes a ring tone composer. Internet connectivity is enabled through support for WAP and the integrated WAP browser. There are other nifty features such as a currency converter and the ability to copy and paste sections of SMS messages into new ones, in addition to its support for T9 predictive text entry. However, one downside to this phone is that there are just two games bundled. In the tests, the phone took a quick 1 hour to recharge completely from a drained condition and the talk time was logged at a respectable 180 minutes. This phone makes a very good choice for users who need plenty of features in a small form factor with intuitive navigation and good battery performance to last you while on the road.

Price: Rs 10,290

Panasonic EB-GD75

B+

Ergonomics ▶▶▶▶▶

Features ▶▶▶▶▶

Performance ▶▶▶▶▶

Warranty ▶▶▶▶▶

OVERALL ▶▶▶▶▶

+ Polyphonic ring tones, large phonebook memory, good standby time, impressive display
- Few games

and even the sheer style of their predecessors.

Budget: Truly embodying fun and ease of use, the Nokia 3350 bagged the Best Performance Award among the budget phones. It incorporates a lot of features at a very good price. While the body has changed slightly compared to the other 3-series phones, the screen offers a higher resolution, which makes WAP

browsing a much more enjoyable experience. In our tests, it showed a quick charging time, good voice clarity and excellent standby time.

The phone that won the Best Value Award in this category was the trusty Nokia 3310. This phone is priced very well and for those who need a good cellular device that is relatively small with a good set of features and who don't

Nokia 8310

Embodying a good combination of looks, functionality and leading edge wireless technology, the Nokia 8310 is one of the smallest phones around. Capable of download speeds of up to 40.2 Kbps, this phone is capable of Internet access through GPRS and HSCSD as well as WAP. This funky tri-colour device features an integrated FM tuner, which is used through the hands-free set that also serves as an antenna. The phone also incorporates the ability to record voice for up to 180 seconds. Like all other

Nokia phones, navigation through the menu system is very simple and there are shortcuts that can take you to any feature in the menu through key combinations. Through the integrated IR interface, you can also exchange data or print on devices that support the standard. You can download ring tones from the Internet along with screensavers and operator logos. This phone has enough memory to hold up to 500 phone numbers and calendar entries, which work in tandem with the To-do lists through which they can be correlated to each other. We found that the voice reception on the phone was quite clear. It performed satisfactorily in the signal strength tests where it registered the network in three of the four zones.



Nokia 8310

A-

Ergonomics ▶▶▶▶▶

Features ▶▶▶▶▶

Performance ▶▶▶▶▶

Warranty ▶▶▶▶▶

OVERALL ▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 21,699

+ GPRS and HSCSD Internet connectivity, FM tuner, small form factor
- No ring tone composer